Module 6: Technology Deployment and Competitor Analysis

Start here — Cerebras

Read before class (5–8 minutes): the three facts and three terms below. The full blog, company summary, filing, and detailed role pages are optional depth unless a specific passage is assigned.

In class: review the worked example, explain the decision in your own words, then read only your assigned role in the student packet. Four leads make decisions; the Account Manager integrates them. The packet works without SkillSimm access.

Three essential facts

- The packet reports 86% of revenue from two related customers.
- R&D was $243.3 million, about 48% of revenue.
- Capacity delivery commitments must be matched to supply and infrastructure the company can actually obtain.

Three terms

- Switching cost: what a customer gives up or must do to change suppliers.
- Ecosystem: tools, partners, and skills surrounding a product.
- Differentiation: a valuable reason to choose one offering over alternatives.

Worked example — discuss before opening the simulation

Illustrative startup: a tool saves five minutes per task but takes a team two days to learn. List the customer's benefits and switching costs before claiming the new tool is better.

Readiness check: What customer outcome improves, and what must the customer give up to switch? Ask a teammate to explain the task back before starting.

What you produce

- **During the simulation:** one decision in words, one supporting figure or passage, one trade-off, and one condition that would change your mind.
- **Account Manager:** rank the four lead decisions 1–4 and allocate 100 priority points in blocks of 10; explain the first priority with evidence. These are priority weights, not course-grade points.
- **Before leaving:** save your individual decision record. If you finish early, start the venture workshop below.
- **After discussion:** submit your individual reflection through the existing HuskyCT assignment. See the reflection guide. Keep the current deadline; from October 20 onward, aim for 300–500 words.

Thursday venture workshop — 15–20 minutes

Compare your venture with two alternatives, including the current way customers solve the problem. List evidence, switching costs, and one test of your claimed advantage.

Output: A competitor comparison table for Final Section C. Add it to your shared project document; this is preparation for the project, not a new separately graded assignment.

Debrief question: What did discussion change about your original decision? Explain the evidence, rather than reporting only an option letter.

Takeaway: A technical advantage matters when customers can realize it after switching costs.

Class rhythm

- **Tuesday (75 minutes):** 10 minutes concept and example; 5 minutes task walkthrough; 10 minutes role reading; 25 minutes decisions and team discussion; 15 minutes comparison; 10 minutes saving evidence and starting the venture application.

- **Thursday (75 minutes):** 10 minutes concept recap; 35 minutes selected role discussion and feedback; 20 minutes venture workshop; 10 minutes decision record and reflection questions.

Read instructions aloud slowly, pause after each step, and invite a student to restate what must be produced. Use the static packet and shared notes if the platform lags; resume the discussion without waiting on the tool.

Access after class

The accompanying StudentPacket.html / .pdf and Debrief.html / .pdf can be opened without joining a simulation group. Save the packet and your own record before leaving. The same resources are linked from the deployed slide folder.